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Santa Fe Institute

Complexity Postdoctoral Fellowship

Opens Jul 26 2026 10:00 PM (MDT)
Deadline Sep 30 2026 11:59 PM (MDT)

Description

The application portal for the 2027 cohort is now closed. We will be accepting applications for 2028 in July 2027.

The **Santa Fe Institute Complexity Postdoctoral Fellowships**, comprising the Omidyar Fellowships, are unique among postdoctoral appointments. The Fellowships offer *early-career* scholars the opportunity to undertake their own independent research within a collaborative research community that nurtures creative, transdisciplinary thought in pursuit of key insights about the complex systems that matter most for science and society. The Institute rejects compartmentalized thought common in academia. Instead, SFI scientists transcend boundaries between fields, freely synthesizing ideas spanning many disciplines – from math, physics, computer science and biology to the social sciences and the humanities – in pursuit of creative insights that advance our scientific frontiers.

Postdoctoral Fellows spend up to three years in residence at SFI, where they contribute to SFI's research in the sciences of complexity and are trained to become leaders in interdisciplinary science. As thought leaders who shape the future of science, Postdoctoral Fellows also participate in a unique training program structured to develop leadership skills throughout their three-year residencies and beyond. The Institute provides an opportunity to collaborate with leading researchers worldwide, discretionary and collaborative funds, and a competitive salary with a generous benefit package including paid family leave.

The Institute has no formal programs or departments. Research is collaborative and spans the physical, natural, and social sciences. Most research is theoretical (SFI does not have lab facilities) and/or computational in nature, although it may include an empirical component. SFI has 21 postdoctoral researchers, 10 resident faculty, 100+ external faculty, and averages 1000 visitors per year. Descriptions of the research themes and interests of the faculty and current Fellows can be found at SFI Research.

Requirements

- a Ph.D. in any scientific discipline granted within 6 years of the application deadline (e.g. after October 2022 and prior to September 2028)
- strong quantitative and computational skills
- an exemplary academic record
- a proven ability to work both independently and collaboratively
- a demonstrated interest in transdisciplinary research
- evidence of the ability to think beyond traditional paradigms

SFI is an equal-opportunity employer. Women, veterans, and members of underrepresented groups are especially encouraged to apply. SFI is responsive to the needs of dual-career couples. Our goal is to recruit an applicant pool that is diverse in every sense: race, class, gender, orientation, nationality, politics, beliefs, disciplinary background, and intellectual outlook.

U.S. citizenship is not a requirement, however, you must be legally able to work in the US. SFI will sponsor a J1 Visa for successful candidates. SFI is not able to sponsor an H1B Visa for candidates.

Required documents

1. Curriculum vitae (including publication list).

2. Statement of research interests (max. 2 pages) including a summary of the research you would like to pursue and why, and what your broader interests are.

3. Description of interest in SFI (max. 1 page) that describes your potential contribution to the SFI community and also explains